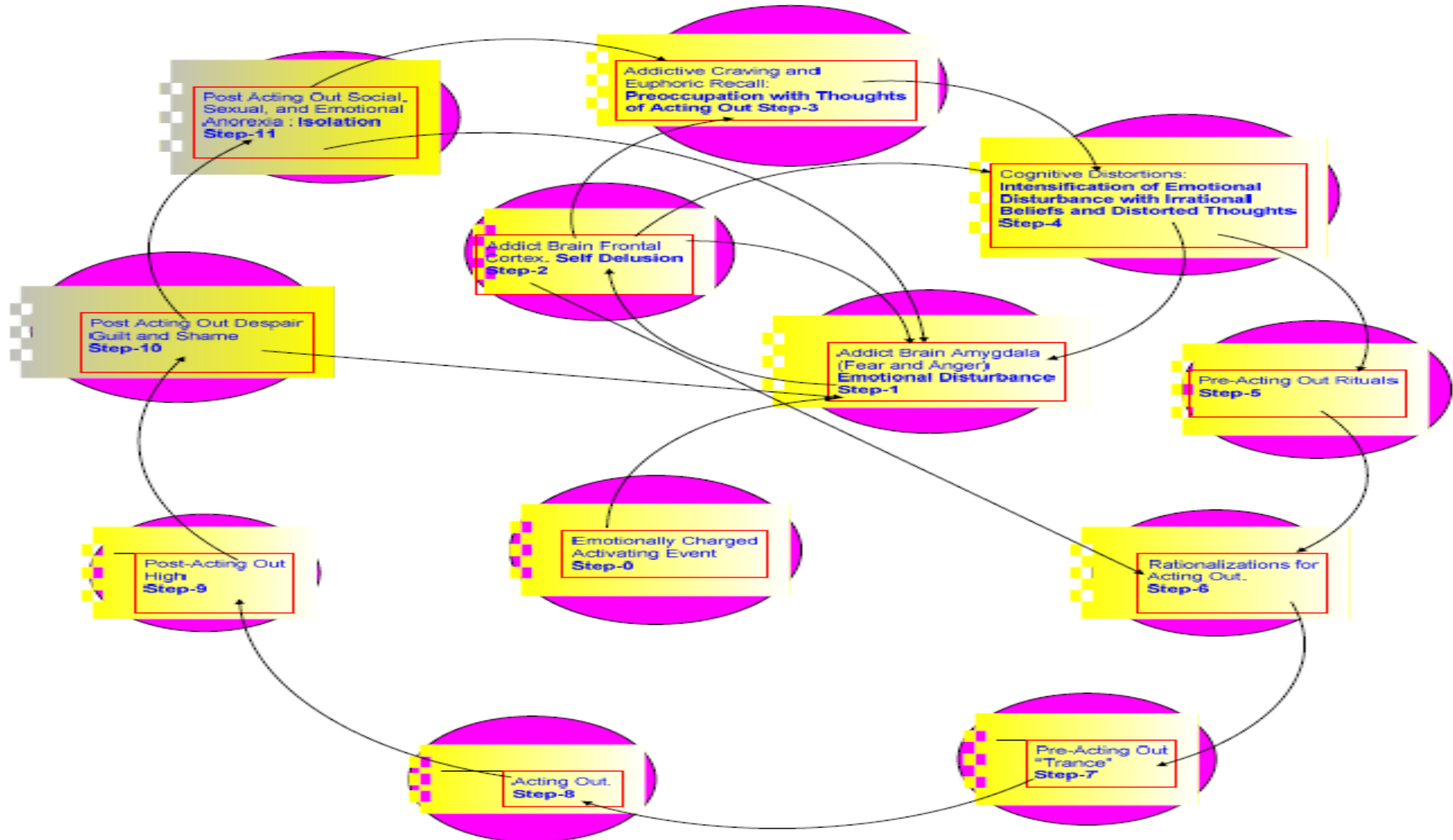


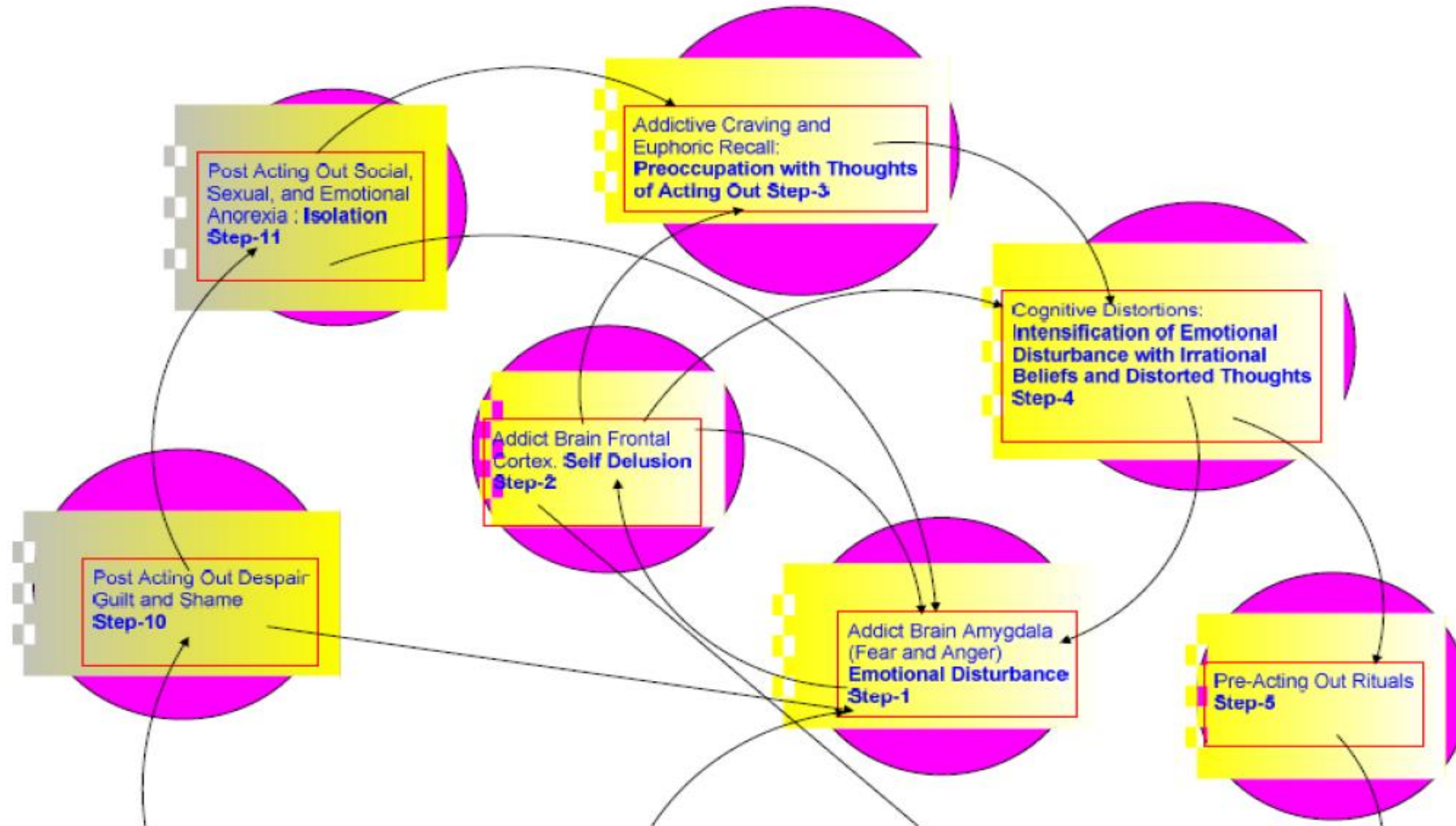
The Addictive Cycle Diagram
A Vital “Relapse Prevention” Tool

Dedicated to the Buddha: the First Addiction Counselor

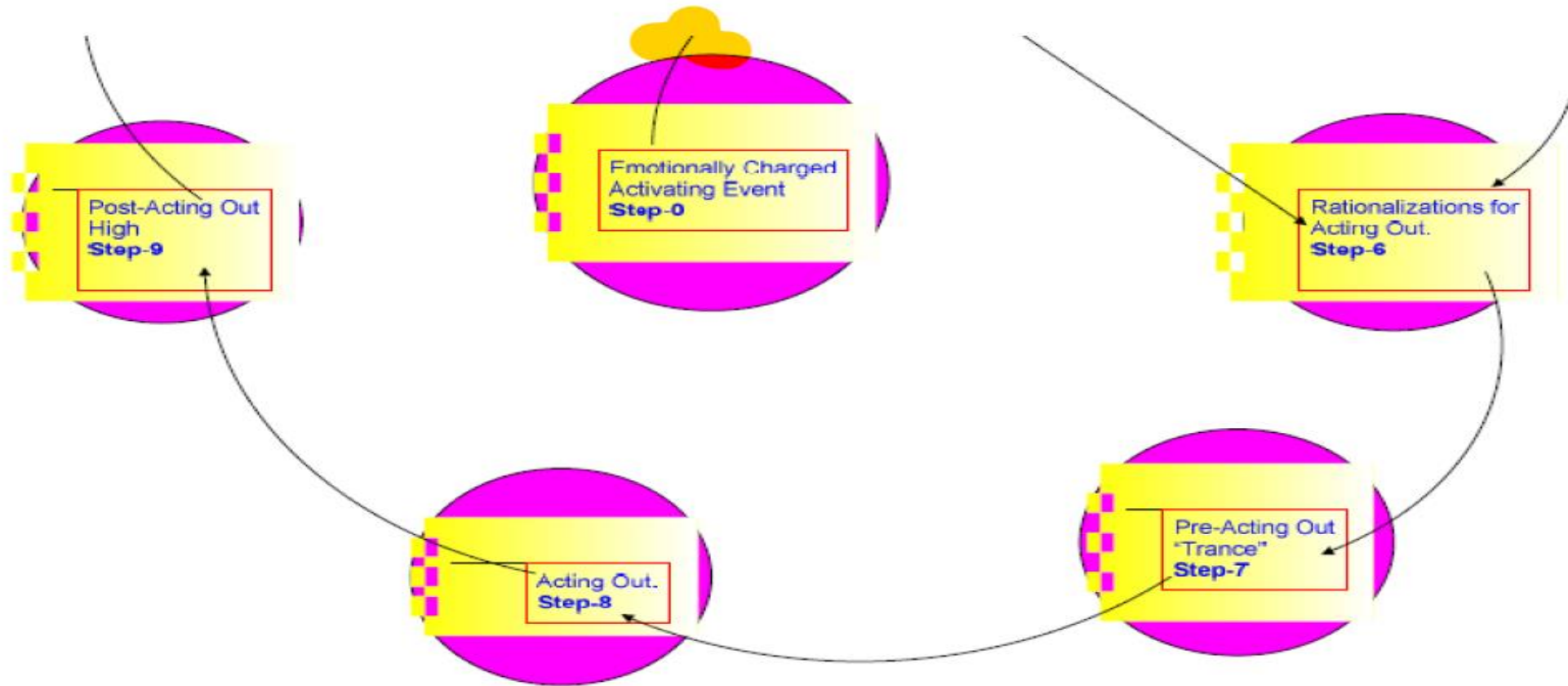
Full Addictive Cycle Diagram(Drawn from Literature of Addiction, Recovery, Neuroscience, and Cognitive Behavior Therapy)



Top Half of Addictive Cycle Diagram(Pre-Acting Out Turmoil, and Post Acting Out Turmoil)



Bottom Half Addictive Cycle Diagram(Addictive Cycle Activating Event..,Rationalization, and Short Term Rewards of Acting Out)



Approach to Relapse Prevention-I

- Apply Remedies as early in the Addictive Cycle diagram as possible
- Appropriate Remedies are stage dependent!
- Example1: at “Self Delusion Stage- 2” call a friend, mentor, or Program sponsor to discuss your “stinking thinking”
- Example2:at Step-4 write down on paper arguments to dispute the irrational and distorted nature of negative self talk
- Example3: at Step-6 write down on paper arguments to dispute rationalizations for acting out, and test the validity of those rationalizations in the light of past acting out history
- Example4: at Step-0 apply meditative/mindfulness techniques to sit with difficult emotional states(Note: this assumes the development of a meditative/mindfulness practice) Alternatively, one can engage in some form of positive distraction, eg. pursuit of a hobby, listening to music, going to Program Meetings etc

Approach to Relapse Prevention-II

- Develop a Journaling Practice that records feelings, and negative self-talk which precede acting out, as well as the results of acting out
- Identify an approach for dealing with each stage on the Addictive Cycle Diagram to Interrupt/Derail the cycle
- Develop some form of Meditative/Mindfulness practice to learn better how to sit with difficult emotions without acting out or alternatively develop a range of Distraction techniques/approaches
- Investigate 12 step groups as a source of support and inspiration and obtain a Sponsor...when you feel on shaky ground, call your sponsor or a close friend immediately!
- Avoid people/places/or things that are intimately associated with your acting out history(**memories of acting out are very powerful and these people/places/or things can be powerful triggers for re-entering the Addictive Cycle Diagram!**)